

Atlas Industries — Password Reset Standard Operating Procedure

Document ID: IT-PWD-002 **Owner:** IT Service Desk **Last Updated:** 18 February 2025
Version: 2.5

1. When to Reset

You should reset your password when:

- It has been compromised or you suspect it has been.
- It is about to expire (you receive a system reminder 14 days, 7 days, and 1 day before expiry).
- You have forgotten it.

Passwords expire **every 90 days** by policy. The same password cannot be re-used within 5 cycles.

2. Self-Service Reset

The fastest path for a forgotten or expiring password:

1. Open `portal.atlas-industries.com/reset` in any browser.
2. Enter your work email address.
3. Approve the MFA push notification on Microsoft Authenticator.
4. Enter your new password twice. The system enforces the password policy in section 4.
5. Sign back in to your laptop and applications using the new password.

The self-service flow has a **24-hour cooldown**: you cannot reset twice within the same day. If you genuinely need a second reset within 24 hours, follow the assisted reset flow in section 3.

3. Assisted Reset

If self-service is unavailable (lost MFA device, locked account, or new hire on day one), call the IT Service Desk:

- Phone: extension **3500** internally, or +20 2 1234 5678 externally.
- Service Desk hours: 08:00 – 20:00 EET, Sunday to Thursday.
- Outside hours, file a ticket at `support@atlas-industries.com` — handled the next business day, unless tagged as an urgent business-impact issue.

You will be asked to verify your identity. Acceptable verifications: - Employee ID + last 4 digits of phone number on file. - Confirmation from your direct manager via Teams. - Government ID number cross-checked with HR records.

4. Password Policy

A new password must:

- Be at least **12 characters** long.
- Include at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.
- Not contain your name, username, or any company name.
- Not be in the published list of breached passwords (the system checks this automatically).

We strongly recommend a passphrase of 4 unrelated words, e.g. Olive-Garden-Yellow-Mountain-7.

5. After a Reset

Most applications pick up the new password automatically after the next sign-in. The exceptions are:

- **Outlook (desktop):** may require closing and reopening.
- **Cisco AnyConnect VPN:** disconnect and reconnect to use the new password.
- **Saved passwords in browsers:** update manually or remove the old saved entry.

If a specific application keeps prompting after the change, file a ticket so we can clear cached credentials from the central directory.

6. Account Lockout

Five consecutive failed sign-ins triggers a **30-minute automatic lockout**. Wait 30 minutes or call the Service Desk for an immediate unlock. Repeated lockouts are reviewed by IT Security.

7. Reporting Suspected Compromise

If you suspect your password has been used by someone else, treat it as a security incident:

1. Reset the password immediately.
 2. Email security@atlas-industries.com with the timestamp and any unusual activity.
 3. Do not delete browser history or device logs — they help investigation.
-

Related: IT-VPN-001, IT-MFA-010, IT-AUP-006.